MENT 2234: Final Project Instructions

Course weight and deadlines

Blogs 10%; simulation reflections 40%; participation 10%; midterm report and video together 20%; final report and video together 20%. Team registration is required setup with no separate course weight. Preserve the existing Blackboard allocation between each report and video; use the video scoring criteria already posted there. Report rubric points (midterm 60 plus up to 4 bonus; final 50) are not course percentages. All existing Blackboard deadlines and cutoff times remain unchanged.

For the final, your team will build on your midterm analysis of the **same company**, apply additional entrepreneurship concepts, and incorporate instructor feedback. You will submit the completed report and a **15-minute final video**.

Project overview

The project uses **one shared report, one company, and two submissions**. The midterm report is worth **60 points, with up to 4 bonus points**, and the final report is worth **50 points**, for **110 raw rubric points in total plus the available bonus points**. Each project keeps its separate 20% course weight; do not calculate the course grade by pooling the 110 report points.

Continue working in your team's existing Google Doc. Add Part 2 below Part 1, and revise the earlier material in response to your midterm feedback. When the Team Leader submits the final task, **SkillSimm captures the document as a final PDF and closes the project run**. Complete all revisions before that submission.

See the Midterm Project Instructions for the company options and the Part 1 requirements. Continue with the company your team selected for the midterm, and check that your research remains accurate and relevant.

Final report: 50 points

Organize Part 2 around the criteria below. Section E involves revising the existing report and checking the complete document.

A. Creative Thinking Application — 10 points · Team Leader

1. Describe the creative problem-solving approaches used.
2. Explain how creativity helped differentiate the venture.
3. Reflect on lessons about innovation from your simulation experience.

B. Common Pitfalls Analysis and Mitigation — 10 points · Member 1

1. Identify common entrepreneurial pitfalls relevant to your chosen company.
2. Analyze which pitfalls your team encountered in the simulation.
3. Propose strategies to avoid or overcome the pitfalls you identified.

C. Acquiring Enterprises Evaluation — 10 points · Member 2

1. Assess acquisition as an alternative growth strategy.
2. Evaluate the due diligence considerations involved in an acquisition.
3. Compare acquiring an existing business with starting a new venture in the context of your chosen company.

D. Franchising Enterprises Assessment — 10 points · Member 3

1. Evaluate whether the business model has franchising potential.
2. Analyze the relationship between a franchisor and its franchisees.
3. Assess relevant regulatory and tax implications.

E. Incorporate Midterm Comments and Polish Writing — 10 points · Member 4

1. Carefully review the instructor's comments on the midterm submission.
2. Revise the report to improve clarity, coherence, and professional presentation.
3. Ensure that suggested improvements are thoughtfully addressed.
4. Proofread for grammar, spelling, and consistent formatting.

Coordinate these revisions with your teammates, since feedback may affect multiple sections of the report.

Final video: 15 minutes

Record and submit a team video based on your chosen company. Cover the following four areas in a clear, well-organized presentation.

A. Business Idea Presentation

1. Briefly introduce the business concept.
2. Make your opening description clear and compelling.

B. Creative Thinking Demonstration

1. Present innovative problem-solving approaches.
2. Demonstrate how opportunities can be recognized and problems reframed.
3. Show how existing resources can be combined in new ways.

C. Common Pitfalls and Success Factors

1. Identify potential pitfalls for the venture.
2. Explain strategies to reduce or manage those risks.
3. Identify success factors and explain how they apply to the company.

D. Acquisition, Franchising, and Partnership Strategy

1. Evaluate acquisition compared with organic growth.
2. Assess franchising potential, if applicable.
3. Identify potential collaboration partners and explain your choices.
4. Discuss venture capital readiness and alignment with the business plan.

Working together and submitting your report

Use your existing shared Google Doc and team chat to coordinate the final. Discuss proposed changes with your teammates so that the report remains consistent and everyone's contributions are represented.

Team role	Final responsibility
Team Leader	Section A: Creative Thinking Application; overall review and final submission
Member 1	Section B: Common Pitfalls Analysis and Mitigation
Member 2	Section C: Acquiring Enterprises Evaluation
Member 3	Section D: Franchising Enterprises Assessment
Member 4	Section E: Incorporate Midterm Comments and Polish Writing

Team members

Complete your assigned work in the shared document, then submit your individual task in SkillSimm. Include a brief, accurate summary of your contribution. Edits in the shared document may appear as "Anonymous," so this summary is used to record your individual contribution.

Team Leader

Your submission task unlocks after all four members have submitted their tasks. In addition to completing Section A:

1. Review the full report, including the revised midterm material and the new final sections.
2. Confirm that the team has thoughtfully addressed the instructor's midterm feedback.
3. Check that the report reads as one cohesive document and that grammar, citations, and formatting are consistent.
4. Confirm that all edits are complete, then submit the final task in SkillSimm.

Submitting the final task captures the report as a PDF and ends the project run. Please allow time for your team's final review before submitting.

Research and sources

SEC filings: compare the filing sequence

Use SEC EDGAR to find available filings. When an IPO filing sequence is available, collect the initial **S-1**, its **S-1/A amendments**, and the **424B4 final prospectus**. The number of amendments may vary.

Compare consecutive versions and look for changes in:

- **Financial information:** revised figures, additional reporting periods, or changes to non-GAAP definitions.
- **Risk disclosures:** risks that were added, clarified, or given greater emphasis.
- **Business descriptions:** changes in how the company describes its activities and strategy.
- **Customer concentration:** new or more detailed information about reliance on particular customers.

Explain what the changes suggest and support your interpretation with evidence. Avoid assuming that a change resulted from SEC or underwriter pressure unless your sources establish that connection. These comparisons can strengthen your midterm analysis of legal compliance, governance, and financial sustainability, as well as your final analysis of risks and growth strategies.

Other useful filings include **10-K annual reports**, **10-Q quarterly reports**, **8-K current reports**, and **DEF 14A proxy statements**, which can provide information about governance, board structure, and compensation.

Alumni interviews

UConn NetWerx can help you connect with alumni. Interviews can add firsthand perspectives on entrepreneurial rewards, challenges, and trade-offs. Obtain consent, take careful notes, and attribute interview insights appropriately in your report.

Additional evidence

Consider company annual letters, policy and engineering blogs, transparency reports, and governance documents. Consult relevant regulatory and industry materials, such as consumer lending requirements for Affirm, aviation and export-control requirements for SpaceX, payment security standards for Stripe, and AI policy frameworks for Anthropic.

Reputable business reporting can help document funding rounds and valuations. Cite the outlet and publication date, and distinguish reported valuations from audited financial information. Cite your sources throughout the report so readers can follow your evidence.

Submission checklist

- Confirm the existing deadline and report/video submission entries in Blackboard.
- Complete all report sections and the 15-minute video, with traceable sources.
- Complete the four members' SkillSimm tasks and the Team Leader's submission workflow above.
- Save the report PDF and video; complete the existing Blackboard submission steps for both deliverables and check the submission receipts.
- Use Blackboard's existing report/video allocation and posted video scoring criteria. This guide does not create a new split.